



IMAGE COURTESY **SAFFRONART**

Mumbai-based Saffronart has recorded strong sales across its 2026 auctions. Its Spring sales generated ₹301 crore compared to ₹245 crore in 2025, followed by ₹108 crore from the Summer Online Auction and ₹250 crore from September Autumn Auctions. It recorded ₹355.77 crore from the 25th Anniversary Evening Sale, and ₹162.14 crore from the Winter Auctions.

The Indian art market has entered what looks like its most consequential decade yet amid a global art market that returned to growth in 2025 after three consecutive years of contraction. It continues to be supported by established collectors, but a younger generation of entrepreneurs, professionals, and high-net-worth individuals is expanding its reach. This new cohort is geographically diverse, digitally comfortable and exposed to international trends. Some are building on family collections; others are entering the market independently.

The Ravi Varma painting was bought by billionaire Cyrus Poonawalla, the founder of one of the world's largest vaccine manufacturers, the Serum Institute in Pune.

Before Ravi Varma, there was M. F. Husain's *Gram Yatra*, which was sold at a whopping ₹118 crore in 2025. Amrita Sher-Gil's *The Storyteller*, which held the world record for the highest value work in 2023, was valued at ₹61.8 crore.

If the numbers by the greats are staggering, the artists awaiting wider recognition are not far behind. Aparna Batra, Chief Business Officer, AstaGuru Auction House, says the demand is expanding beyond the Progressive Artists' Group to artists such as J. Swaminathan, Manjit Bawa, Bhupen Khakhar, and B. Prabha.

"At our Manifest auction, S.H. Raza's *La Provence Noire* fetched ₹48.7 crore, becoming his second most expensive work. Among female artists, B. Prabha has seen strong demand. Her signature-style work fetched ₹2.19 crore in June, setting an auction record for



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"I would like to see India move from participation to leadership. We have done a great deal to preserve and share our heritage. Now we must play a much more active role in shaping global cultural conversations"